The launch comes amid growing pressure on organisations to retain control over their technology infrastructure as regulatory requirements tighten and AI workloads intensify sovereignty concerns. Digital sovereignty now extends beyond data residency to include who operates the systems, how data is governed, where workloads run, and under whose jurisdiction AI models operate. Many organisations currently lack a modern platform to re-host applications, modernise workloads, deploy AI, and maintain continuous compliance reporting.

Built on Red Hat's open source foundation, IBM Sovereign Core embeds sovereignty directly into the software rather than layering controls afterwards. It enables customer-operated control planes, in-boundary identity and encryption key management, continuous compliance evidence generation, and governed AI inference using local GPU clusters without exporting data externally. Deployment can be completed within days, with flexibility across on-premises infrastructure, in-region clouds, and IT service providers.

"As AI adoption accelerates in India, businesses will need to innovate while meeting tightening regulatory requirements," said Sandip Patel, managing director, IBM India & South Asia, adding that Sovereign Core delivers control, compliance, and operational autonomy while avoiding infrastructure lock-in through open standards.

IBM will initially roll out the software with its European partners, Cegeka and Computacenter. A tech preview is scheduled for February 2026, with general availability planned for mid-2026.

G42 releases NANDA 87B, a Hindi-English LLM built on Llama

Abu Dhabi-based AI group G42 has released NANDA 87B, an open source Hindi-English large language model with 87 billion parameters, strengthening the availability of high-scale open AI for one of the world's largest language communities.

NANDA 87B is available as an open-weight model on the MBZUAI Hugging Face page, allowing developers, researchers, startups, and enterprises to use, modify, and extend the model without vendor lock-in. The release marks a major upgrade over G42's earlier NANDA model, significantly increasing both scale and capability.

The model is designed specifically for Hindi, English, and Hinglish, and has been trained on more than 65 billion Hindi tokens using a Hindi-centric tokeniser to improve training efficiency and inference performance. Built on Llama-3.1 70B, NANDA 87B extends an established open model foundation rather than relying on closed architectures.

Development was led by Mohamed bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence (MBZUAI) in collaboration with Inception, a G42 company, and chipmaker Cerebras. Training was carried out on Condor Galaxy, the AI supercomputing system built by G42 and Cerebras.

"India deserves world-class technology that speaks its language. NANDA 87B is a major step in that direction," said Manu Jain, chief executive of G42 India, noting that the model is intended to support education, entertainment, and enterprise use cases across India's AI ecosystem.

Top researchers return to OpenAI

OpenAI has welcomed back three high-profile researchers, Barret Zoph, Luke Metz, and Sam Schoenholz, following their brief tenure at former OpenAI CTO Mira Murati's AI startup, Thinking Machines. Their return comes at a critical time, reinforcing OpenAI's technical leadership amid intense competition for AI talent, particularly from Google.

Under the new organisational structure, Barret Zoph reports directly to OpenAI applications CEO Fidji Simo, while Metz and Schoenholz report to Zoph. Simo confirmed that the return had been in the works for several weeks. While specific project details remain undisclosed, the trio's comeback is expected to strengthen OpenAI's core research and post-training capabilities.

Thinking Machines, launched by Murati in early 2025 as a public benefit corporation based in San Francisco, focuses on building collaborative multimodal AI systems with humans rather than fully automated AI. Murati announced Zoph's exit from the startup on X, stating: "We have parted ways with Barret Zoph. Soumith Chintala will be the new CTO of Thinking Machines."

This move is expected to accelerate development in multimodal AI systems and reinforce OpenAI's role in advancing accessible, transparent, and human-centric AI technologies.